



Twitter Articles

Twitter may reportedly be working on a new feature called Articles which allows for longer posts. <https://digit.in/mar22-25>



Magenta fleet mgt system

Magenta implements new fleet mgt system under the EVET brand which offers real-time insights. <https://digit.in/mar25-26>

Sonos Roam

One of the better-sounding portable speakers

Sonos recently entered the Indian wireless speaker market to much fanfare. Given that the Sonos Move already impressed us tremendously and won the Digit Zero1 Award for the Best Performing Wireless Speaker of 2021, our expectations were high. Priced at ₹19,999, the Sonos Roam is a portable, Bluetooth speaker with Wi-Fi connectivity as well. Can it set itself apart from the competition to be worth 20K. Let's find out.



fair number of features. One such feature is called Sound Swap. What this feature does is, allow you to "throw" the music from your Sonos Roam speaker to the nearest Sonos speaker in the area, and vice versa.

The speaker works on both Bluetooth v5.0 and Wi-Fi. It has something called an Automatic Switching feature that connects the speaker to Wi-Fi automatically when in range. The speaker also supports Apple AirPlay 2,

Price
₹21,999

which is excellent for iOS users. The speaker is also compatible with the Sonos app.

Now, the speaker is also compatible with Google Assistant and Alexa in some countries, however, the feature isn't available in India yet, which is very disappointing. This is one



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BUILD AND DESIGN

With the Sonos Roam, the company retains the minimalist, classy aesthetic present in previous devices such as the Move. However, one major distinguishing factor is that, with the Roam, Sonos has focused much more on portability and overall ruggedness. The speaker is pretty diminutive, weighing merely 0.43 kg. The Roam is easily portable and can be carried around in a bag or purse. The speaker boasts a honeycomb grille, however, it doesn't wrap all the way around the speaker's body so you won't get 360-degree sound. The speaker is rated IP67 dust and water resistant which makes a worthwhile outdoors speaker.

The control buttons are on the left side of the speaker (when placed horizontally). There's volume controls, a pause/play button, and a microphone button. The pause/play button has multiple functions and can be used to seek tracks as well.

of the main attractions of the speaker since it basically transforms the Roam into a smart speaker (on Wi-Fi only) capable of controlling itself handsfree, controlling other smart home devices, answering questions via the web, and more. So, it's a shame that Indian users who buy this device will not be able to access this feature.

The Sonos Roam also comes with a feature called Automatic Trueplay that optimises the sound for the location or environment you've placed it in. In our testing, we noticed minor tuning differences in different environments. Lastly, the speaker supports Qi wireless charging as well.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with two Class-H digital amplifiers, one tweeter, and one

mid-woofer, the Sonos Roam delivers powerful audio which is surprising given its compact size. The sound isn't 360-degree but it fills a medium-sized room with ease.

The bass response is slightly over-emphasised but that works well in open environments since you can still feel the punchiness. The bass response is hefty, but still controlled enough to avoid too much auditory masking.

The mids are detailed and clear, however, the low highs are slightly weak in the mix therefore, you will lose some detail in cymbals and hi-hats. The overall representation of the music is slightly bass-biased but we prefer that in outdoor speakers. If you're using the speaker indoors, you can EQ down the bass response slightly for it to be less jarring indoors.

As for battery life, Sonos promises up to 10 hours of wireless playtime (at moderate volume levels). We listened to the speaker at about 55-60 percent volume and it lasted roughly 8.5 hours in our tests. The speaker can also last up to 10 days in sleep mode. The speaker automatically goes into this mode when not in use.

VERDICT

Priced at ₹19,999, the Sonos Roam is a luxury portable speaker that impresses in more ways than one. Be it the seamless Wi-Fi + Bluetooth connectivity, powerful audio, or IP67 rugged build, the Sonos Roam justifies its price point, especially for those with an existing Sonos speaker system at home. However, the battery life, at 10 hours, is pretty lacklustre at this price. Overall, the speaker is extremely impressive when it comes to sound, connectivity and build, but isn't quite perfect.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

SPEAKERS: 2 class-H digital amplifiers driving one tweeter and one mid-woofer | **DIMENSIONS:** 168 x 62 x 60mm | **WEIGHT:** 430g | **CONNECTIVITY:** Wi-Fi 5, Bluetooth 5, AirPlay 2, Spotify Connect | **BATTERY:** 10 hours playback | **CHARGING:** USB-C (up to 15W; 5V/1.5A or higher), Qi wireless | **WATER RESISTANCE:** IP67

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FEATURES

The Sonos Roam comes packing a